

SINGLE

1. Passage anchor

> “...and keep the quality steady **every single time**.”

Passage meaning

every single time = every time without exception; emphasizes completeness

每一次都；每一回都毫無例外

Here, **single** is an intensifier emphasizing that the quality needs to be consistent on every occasion.

Practice

1. The cakes need to taste the same **every single time**.

蛋糕需要**每一次**吃起來都一樣。

2. She checks every order **every single time** before delivery.

她在送貨前**每次都**會檢查每一張訂單。

Core meanings of SINGLE

2. single — one only

= only one; not two or more

單一的；只有一個的

Examples

1. I need a **single copy** of the document.

我只需要**一份**文件。

2. Not a **single person** complained.

一個人也沒有**抱怨**。

This is the central numerical sense.

3. a single + noun

= one individual item/person

****一個；單一****

Examples

1. She ate a ****single cookie****.
她吃了一塊****曲奇****。
2. We did not receive a ****single order**** that morning.
那天早上我們****一張訂單也沒有收到****。

Emphatic use

4. every single

= every one, with strong emphasis

****每一個都；每一次都****

This is the exact passage branch.

Examples

1. I checked ****every single order****.
我檢查了****每一張訂單****。
2. She remembers ****every single detail****.
她記得****每一個細節****。

5. not a single

= not even one

****連一個也沒有****

Examples

1. There was ****not a single mistake****.
****一個錯誤也沒有****。
2. Not a ****single customer**** complained.
****沒有一位顧客****抱怨。

Unmarried

6. single — not married / not in a romantic relationship

= not married, and often not currently in a romantic relationship

****單身的；未婚的****

Examples

1. She is ****single****.

她目前****單身****。

2. He has been ****single**** for two years.

他已經****單身****兩年。

Major distinct everyday sense.

7. single person

= unmarried or unattached person

****單身人士****

Examples

1. The event is popular with ****single people****.

這個活動很受****單身人士****歡迎。

2. Housing costs can be difficult for a ****single person****.

對****單身人士****來說，住房成本可能很高。

One person / one occupancy

8. single room

= hotel room intended for one person

****單人房****

Examples

1. I booked a ****single room****.

我訂了一間****單人房****。

2. The hotel has both single and double rooms.

酒店同時有**單人房**和雙人房。

9. single bed

= bed intended for one person

單人床

Examples

1. The room has a **single bed**.

房間裡有一張**單人床**。

2. She bought a new **single bed**.

她買了一張新的**單人床**。

Travel / ticketing

10. single — one-way ticket

Especially BrE:

= ticket for travel in one direction only

單程票

Examples

1. I'd like a **single** to Oxford.

我想買一張去牛津的**單程票**。

2. A **single ticket** costs less than a return.

單程票比來回票便宜。

11. single vs return

single

= one-way ticket

單程票

return

= ticket covering outward and return journeys

****來回票****

Music

12. single — individual song release

= song released separately, often to promote an album

****單曲****

Examples

1. The band released a new ****single****.

樂隊推出了一首新****單曲****。

2. The ****single**** reached number one.

這首****單曲****登上第一名。

Major modern noun sense.

13. lead single

= main single released to promote an album or project

****主打單曲****

Examples

1. This song was the album's ****lead single****.

這首歌是專輯的****主打單曲****。

2. The ****lead single**** became a major hit.

這首****主打單曲****大受歡迎。

Baseball

14. single — one-base hit

= baseball hit that allows the batter to reach first base safely

****一壘安打****

Examples

1. He hit a **single** to left field.
他擊出一支左外野**一壘安打**。

2. The inning began with a **single**.
這一局以一支**一壘安打**開始。

Distinct sports sense.

One unit / individual item

15. single — individual unit

= one separate unit rather than a group or combined set

單件；單個；單一單位

Examples

1. The product can be bought as a **single** or in a pack.
這項產品可以**單個購買**，也可以買整包。

2. Each **single** is wrapped separately.
每個**單件產品**都獨立包裝。

Computing / technical

16. single-user

= intended for one user at a time

單一使用者的；單人使用的

Examples

1. This is a **single-user license**.
這是**單一使用者授權**。

2. The software supports both single-user and multi-user modes.
軟體同時支援**單人使用**和多人使用模式。

17. single-use

= intended to be used only once

****一次性的；單次使用的****

Examples

1. The café is reducing ****single-use plastics****.

咖啡店正在減少****一次性塑膠製品****。

2. This is a ****single-use container****.

這是一個****一次性容器****。

Verb: choose one person/thing

18. single out

= choose one person or thing from a group for special attention, praise, criticism, etc.

****挑出；特別指出；單獨針對****

Examples

1. The manager ****singled her out for praise****.

經理****特別表揚了她****。

2. He felt he had been ****singled out for criticism****.

他覺得自己被****單獨挑出來批評****。

Very high-value phrasal verb.

Related forms

19. singly

= one at a time; separately

****逐一地；個別地****

Examples

1. The items were wrapped ****singly****.

這些物品被****逐件包裝****。

2. The participants entered ****singly****.

參加者****逐一進入****。

20. singleness

= state of being single, especially unmarried

****單身狀態****

Examples

1. She enjoys her ****singleness****.

她享受自己的****單身生活****。

2. The article discusses marriage and ****singleness****.

這篇文章討論婚姻與****單身狀態****。

High-value expressions

21. every single day / time / one

= every day/time/one without exception

****每天都 / 每次都 / 每一個都****

Examples

1. She practises ****every single day****.

她****每天都****練習。

2. He checks ****every single one****.

他****每一個都****會檢查。

22. not a single one

= none at all

****一個也沒有****

Examples

1. ****Not a single one**** was damaged.

****一個也沒有****損壞。

2. I didn't recognize ****a single one**** of them.

他們當中我****一個也認不出來****。

23. single-handed / single-handedly

= done by one person without help

****單槍匹馬地；獨力地****

Examples

1. She ****single-handedly**** ran the stall all day.

她整天****獨力經營****那個攤位。

2. He almost ****single-handedly**** saved the project.

他幾乎****憑一己之力****救回了這個專案。

Useful lexicalized extension.

24. single-minded

= strongly focused on one goal

****專心一致的；一心一意的****

Examples

1. She was ****single-minded**** about building the business.

她對建立這門生意非常****專注、一心一意****。

2. His ****single-minded determination**** impressed everyone.

他那種****一心一意的決心****令所有人印象深刻。

Key contrasts

25. single vs one

****one****

= number 1

****__****

****single****

= one only, often emphasizing separation or absence of others

****單一的；只有一個的****

Compare:

> one cake

> 一個蛋糕

> a single cake

> ****只有一個蛋糕****

26. single vs individual

****individual****

= separate and considered independently

****個別的；單獨的****

****single****

= emphasizes one rather than several

****單一的****

27. single vs alone

****single****

= unmarried or one only

****單身 / 單一****

****alone****

= without other people present

****獨自****

A single person does not necessarily live alone.

28. single vs unmarried

****unmarried****

= legally not married

****未婚的****

****single****

= often broader in everyday usage and can imply not currently in a romantic relationship

****單身的****

29. single vs solo

****solo****

= performed or done by one person alone

****獨奏 / 獨自完成的****

****single****

= broader numerical/status term

Compare:

> solo performance

> 獨奏 / 獨演

> single ticket

> 單程票

Meaning map

The central concept of ****single**** is:

****one rather than more than one****

From this develop:

Passage

every single time

→ ****每一次都****

Quantity

a single item

→ ****單一物件****

Relationship

single

→ **單身**

Hotel

single room

→ **單人房**

Travel

single ticket

→ **單程票**

Music

single

→ **單曲**

Baseball

single

→ **一壘安打**

Selection

single out

→ **從一群中單獨挑出**

The common semantic thread is **one isolated unit/person rather than a group or pair**.

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
single — one only	只有一個的；單一的
a single + noun	一個單獨的某人 / 某物
every single	強調每一個 / 每一次都毫無例外
not a single	連一個也沒有
single — relationship status	未婚或目前沒有伴侶的；單身的
single person	單身人士
single room	供一人入住的單人房
single bed	供一人睡的單人床
single — ticket	單程票，尤其英式英語
single — music	獨立發行的一首歌曲；單曲
lead single	用來主力宣傳專輯的主打單曲

single — baseball	讓打者安全到達一壘的一壘安打	
single — individual unit	一件 / 一個單獨出售或處理的單位	
single-user	供單一使用者使用的	
single-use	只設計使用一次的；一次性的	
single out	從一群中挑出某人 / 某物給予特別注意	
singly	一個接一個 / 逐一地	
singleness	單身狀態	
single-handedly	沒有他人幫助地；獨力完成	
single-minded	對一個目標極度專注、一心一意的	

Passage recap

> “...and keep the quality steady ****every single time****.”

Here:

****single**** = an emphatic word strengthening ****every****

****every single time****

= ****every time, without any exception****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* ****每一次都****

* ****每回都毫無例外****

* contextually: ****每次都保持穩定****

Natural contextual translation:

****以及每一次都保持穩定的品質。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****every single****

= ****every one or every occasion, with strong emphasis that there are no exceptions****

****每一個都；每一次都****

The key learner contrasts are:

> ****single person****

> → 單身人士

> ****single room****

> → 單人房

> ****single ticket****

> → 單程票

> ****a music single****

> → 單曲

> ****baseball single****

> → 一壘安打

> ****single someone out****

> → ****把某人單獨挑出來****

So in the passage, ****single**** does not mean unmarried or “one item.” It acts as an ****emphatic modifier****: quality must stay consistent ****every single time, with no exceptions****.